Switching java version

Switching Java Versions on Windows

Show thinking

Yes, absolutely! Since Windows 11 uses **PowerShell** by default, the cleanest and most modern way to do this is by adding a custom "Function" to your PowerShell Profile.

This will let you type `switchjava22` or `switchjava25` at any time to instantly swap versions for that session.

Here is how to set it up step-by-step.

The PowerShell Way (Recommended for Windows 11)

Your PowerShell "Profile" is a script that runs every time you open a new terminal window. We can add custom commands to it.

Step 1: Open your PowerShell Profile

1. Open your Windows Terminal (PowerShell).
2. Type the following command and press Enter to open your profile in Notepad:

PowerShell

```
notepad $PROFILE
```

Step 2: Add the Custom Commands

1. In the Notepad window that opens, paste the following code:

PowerShell

```
function switchjava22 {
    $env:JAVA_HOME="C:\Program Files\Java\jdk-22"
    $env:Path="$env:JAVA_HOME\bin;" + $env:Path
    Write-Host "Active: Java 22" -ForegroundColor Green
    java -version
}

function switchjava25 {
    $env:JAVA_HOME="C:\Program Files\Java\jdk-25"
    $env:Path="$env:JAVA_HOME\bin;" + $env:Path
    Write-Host "Active: Java 25" -ForegroundColor Green
    java -version
}
```

(Make sure the folder paths like `jdk-22` and `jdk-25` match exactly what is inside your `C:\Program Files\Java\` folder).

2. **Save** the file (Ctrl + S) and close Notepad.

Step 3: Refresh your Terminal

Close your terminal window and open a new one. Now, just type `switchjava25` and press Enter. It will instantly swap your environment variables and show you the updated version!

Code:

```
function switchjava22 {
   $env:JAVA_HOME="C:\Program Files\Java\jdk-22"
   $env:Path="$env:JAVA_HOME\bin;" + $env:Path
   Write-Host "Active: Java 22" -ForegroundColor
Green
   java -version
}

function switchjava25 {
   $env:JAVA_HOME="C:\Program Files\Java\jdk-25"
   $env:Path="$env:JAVA_HOME\bin;" + $env:Path
   Write-Host "Active: Java 25" -ForegroundColor
Green
   java -version
}
```

Set in the terminal:

The Command Prompt (cmd) Way

If you prefer using the older Command Prompt instead of PowerShell, the profile method above won't work. Instead, you create tiny scripts.

1. Create a new folder on your C: drive called C:\Scripts.
2. Open Notepad and paste this code:

```
@echo off
set JAVA_HOME=C:\Program Files\Java\jdk-22
set PATH=%JAVA_HOME%\bin;%PATH%
echo Switched to Java 22
java -version
```

---

3. Save it as switchjava22.bat inside C:\Scripts.
4. Create a second file with the Java 25 paths and save it as switchjava25.bat in the same folder.
5. Search for **"Environment Variables"** in your Windows Start menu and open it.
6. Under "User variables", find the variable named **Path**, select it, and click **Edit**.
7. Click **New**, type C:\Scripts, and click **OK** on all the windows.

The Command Prompt (cmd) Way

If you prefer using the older Command Prompt instead of PowerShell, the profile method above won't work. Instead, you create tiny scripts.

1. Create a new folder on your C: drive called `C:\Scripts`.
2. Open Notepad and paste this code:

DOS

```
@echo off
set JAVA_HOME=C:\Program Files\Java\jdk-22
set PATH=%JAVA_HOME%\bin;%PATH%
echo Switched to Java 22
java -version
```

3. Save it as `switchjava22.bat` inside `C:\Scripts`.
4. Create a second file with the Java 25 paths and save it as `switchjava25.bat` in the same folder.
5. Search for **"Environment Variables"** in your Windows Start menu and open it.
6. Under "User variables", find the variable named **Path**, select it, and click **Edit**.
7. Click **New**, type `C:\Scripts`, and click **OK** on all the windows.